

Choose the Lake

Decision card 1 of 3

Two nearby waters; two different search plans

Choose from conditions, not reputation

Pine and North are not interchangeable. Pick the water whose structure matches the day, then use the first hour to test a simple prediction. This is a search plan, not a promise of fish.

The durable difference

	Pine Lake	North Lake
Identity	WBIC 779200; spring lake	WBIC 850800; drainage lake
Scale	711 acres; 85 ft maximum; 39 ft mean	440 acres; 78.4 ft maximum
Recorded bottom	90% gravel; 5% sand; 5% muck	50% sand; 30% gravel; 20% muck
First mental model	Deep, hard-bottom structure; long search lines	Mixed bottom and connected water; cover transitions and moving water

Pick in sixty seconds

Choose Pine when

- you can search depth efficiently;
- low light or broken surface reduces visibility;
- you want to test steep breaks, hard-bottom edges, or suspended marks;
- your boat and crew suit a larger open-water search.

Choose North when

- wind makes a smaller search footprint attractive;
- you want to test mixed-bottom transitions, weeds, necks, or inflow;
- you can move quietly through confined water;
- traffic and posted local rules allow the plan.

CONDITIONS OVER CARD

Check the live forecast, launch status, posted ordinances, and current water-specific fishing rules. Do not use this sheet for navigation.

Make one prediction

Write one sentence before launching:

Because _____, fish should be _____, so I will test _____ until _____.

Example: “Wind has pushed food onto a gravel edge, so I will make three controlled passes.” A prediction makes moving useful; random movement only changes scenery.

The first-hour search

1. Spend 10 minutes observing: temperature, wind lane, clarity, weeds, surface activity, and marks.
2. Fish one structural idea at two depths or speeds for 20 minutes.
3. Change *one* variable and repeat for 20 minutes.
4. At 50 minutes, choose: refine, change pattern, or leave.

Evidence. Wisconsin DNR lake records, WBIC 779200 and 850800, checked 2026-07-26. Tactical interpretations are explicitly editorial hypotheses. Full claim ledger: project shared research.